



English ▾

Consent

Welcome and thank you for your interest in our research on the fediverse!

Who are we?

We are Dr Carlos Cámara-Menoyo (@ccamara@scholar.social) and Dr. Nate Tkacz (@__nate__@mstdn.social), both working at the [Centre for Interdisciplinary Methodologies \(University of Warwick\)](#) as Senior Research Software Engineer and Reader, respectively. You can email us with any questions or comments about this questionnaire or research at carlos.camara@warwick.ac.uk.

What are our interests?

This study examines motivations, usage patterns and expectations of Mastodon users.

What is in this questionnaire?

We ask about information about you (interests,

expectations and concerns), your experience so far with Mastodon, and the degree of knowledge about some mastodon-related concepts. **All data will be collected anonymously and we will not have any way to trace your answers to you** (unless you explicitly share your details with us).

How long does it take?

The questionnaire has up to 40 questions (depending on your choices), some of which are optional. Most questions are closed-answer and do not require typing. It takes about 8-10 minutes to complete the questionnaire.

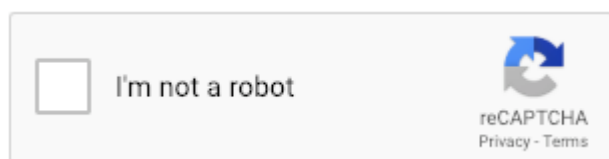
Click on the below to consent to take part in our study, to which the following apply:

- You can leave the study at any time without penalty.
- If you leave before completing the study then your data will not be included in our analysis.
- Your data will be stored on the Qualtrics platform and analysed by the above researchers. All data will be stored in a secure location and is GDPR compliant.

The University's Research Privacy Notice can be viewed here: [Research privacy notice](#)

- ☐ **Yes** - I consent to take part in the study. I have read and understood the above text.
- ☐ No

Are you human?



About yourself

First, tell us a little bit about yourself...

Do you identify with any of these groups?

Select as many as needed

- ☐ Activist
- ☐ Journalist
- ☐ Researcher
- ☐ Coder / Hacker
- ☐ Early adopter
- ☐ None of the above

Could you indicate how important or unimportant the following topics are for you?

	Not at all important	Slightly important	Somewhat important	Extremely important	I do not know
Civil rights	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Free speech	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Politics	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Privacy & security	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Open Culture	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Free/Libre Open Source Software	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Digital sovereignty /autonomy	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

OPTIONAL: Do you have any other interests which you think are relevant for this research and you want to share with us?

Separate multiple interests with a comma (,) or leave blank

According to you, which of these statements is closer to your notion of freedom speech?

- ☐ Anyone should be able to say anything in any circumstance, **without conditions or limits**
- ☐ Anyone should be able to say anything in any circumstance, **as long as it is not aimed at promoting hate against other people because of their ethnicity, gender, social class, ideology and/or religion.**
- ☐ Anyone should be able to say anything in any circumstance, **as long as it does not go against any of the fundamental rights and freedoms established in the laws** (i.e. Constitution, penal law...)
- ☐ I do not know / I do not want to answer

Validation

Do you have at least one Mastodon account?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Do you have (or have had) an account on any of these social media platforms?

- ☐ Twitter
- ☐ Facebook
- ☐ Instagram
- ☐ Parler
- ☐ Sina Weibo
- ☐ Truth Social
- ☐ Other
- ☐ None of the above

If you selected "other", please specify them.

Mastodon

OK, here come the questions about Mastodon



How did you learn about Mastodon?

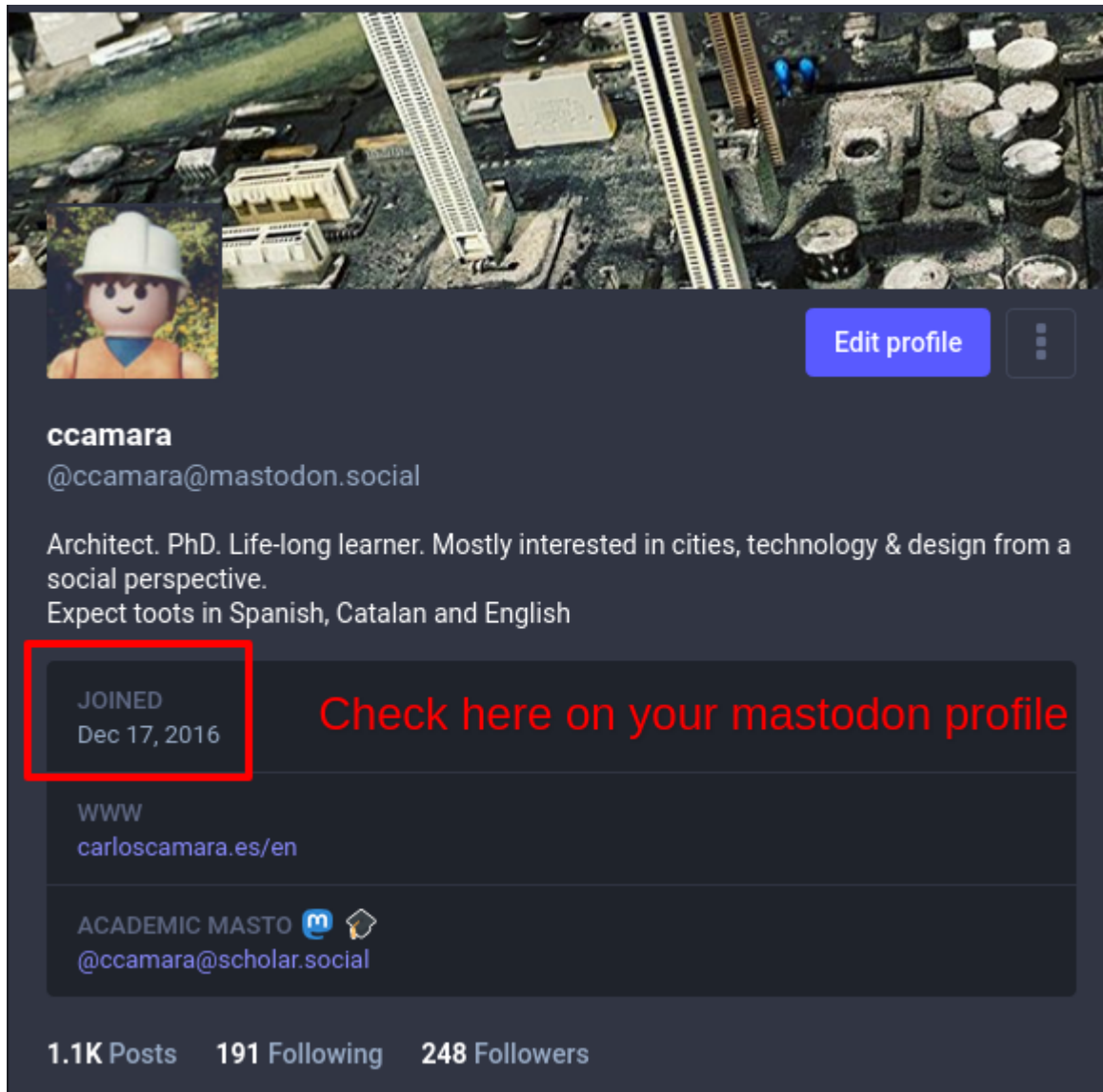
- ☐ Twitter
- ☐ Friends
- ☐ Traditional media (Newspapers, TV...)
- ☐ Specialised media
- ☐ Other federated services
- ☐ Other

When did you first create your Mastodon account?

- ☐ I know exactly the date I joined and I'm willing to introduce it (thanks! that would be very useful. You'll be asked to enter that date in the next question)
- ☐ Less than 3 months ago
- ☐ Between 3 months one year ago
- ☐ Between one year and three years ago
- ☐ More than three years ago

When did you first join Mastodon?

You can find that information in your Mastodon profile



ccamara
@ccamara@mastodon.social

Architect. PhD. Life-long learner. Mostly interested in cities, technology & design from a social perspective.
Expect toots in Spanish, Catalan and English

JOINED
Dec 17, 2016

Check here on your mastodon profile

WWW
carloscamara.es/en

ACADEMIC MASTO  
@ccamara@scholar.social

1.1K Posts 191 Following 248 Followers

Month

Day

Year

How often are you currently using Mastodon?

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Once a week
- ☐ 2-3 times a week
- ☐ 4-6 times a week
- ☐ Daily

How do you access Mastodon?

- ☐ Website
- ☐ Desktop App
- ☐ Phone/Tablet App
- ☐ Other Federated service

Which Desktop app(s) do you usually use?

Do not include apps that you've only used for a short time and are no longer using

- ☐ Tokodon
- ☐ Whalebird
- ☐ TheDesk
- ☐ Hyper-space
- ☐ Mast (Mac)
- ☐ Mastonaut (Mac)
- ☐ Sengi
- ☐ Bitlbee-Mastodon
- ☐ Other

Which Mobile app(s) do you usually use?

Do not include apps that you've only used for a short time and are no longer using

- ☐ Official Mastodon App
- ☐ Tusky (Android)
- ☐ Subway Tooter
- ☐ Fedilab
- ☐ tooot
- ☐ Toot!
- ☐ Mast
- ☐ Amaroq
- ☐ iMast
- ☐ Mercury
- ☐ Metatext
- ☐ Other

How decisive these factors were when you decided to join Mastodon?

	Not decisive at all	Not very decisive	Somewhat decisive	Very decisive	I do not know
I wanted to try a new social network	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of my friends and people I follow are already using Mastodon	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was attracted by these Mastodon unique features					
Code of conduct	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Sorting content by date	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Moderation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mastodon is opensource	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mastodon is federated	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Lack of advertisements	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Not owned by a big company	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Ability to write up to 500 characters in a toot	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was looking for an alternative to Twitter					

I'm concerned
about Elon Musk
acquiring Twitter

☐☐☐☐☐

I'm concerned by
latest events in
Twitter

☐☐☐☐☐

I'm concerned that
Twitter may
dissappear

☐☐☐☐☐

I'm dissatisfied with
Twitter and
mastodon seemed
like an alternative

☐☐☐☐☐

I was looking for an
alternative to Truth
Social

I wasn't happy with
Truth social and
mastodon seemed
like an alternative

☐☐☐☐☐

How many Mastodon accounts do you have?

Type a number

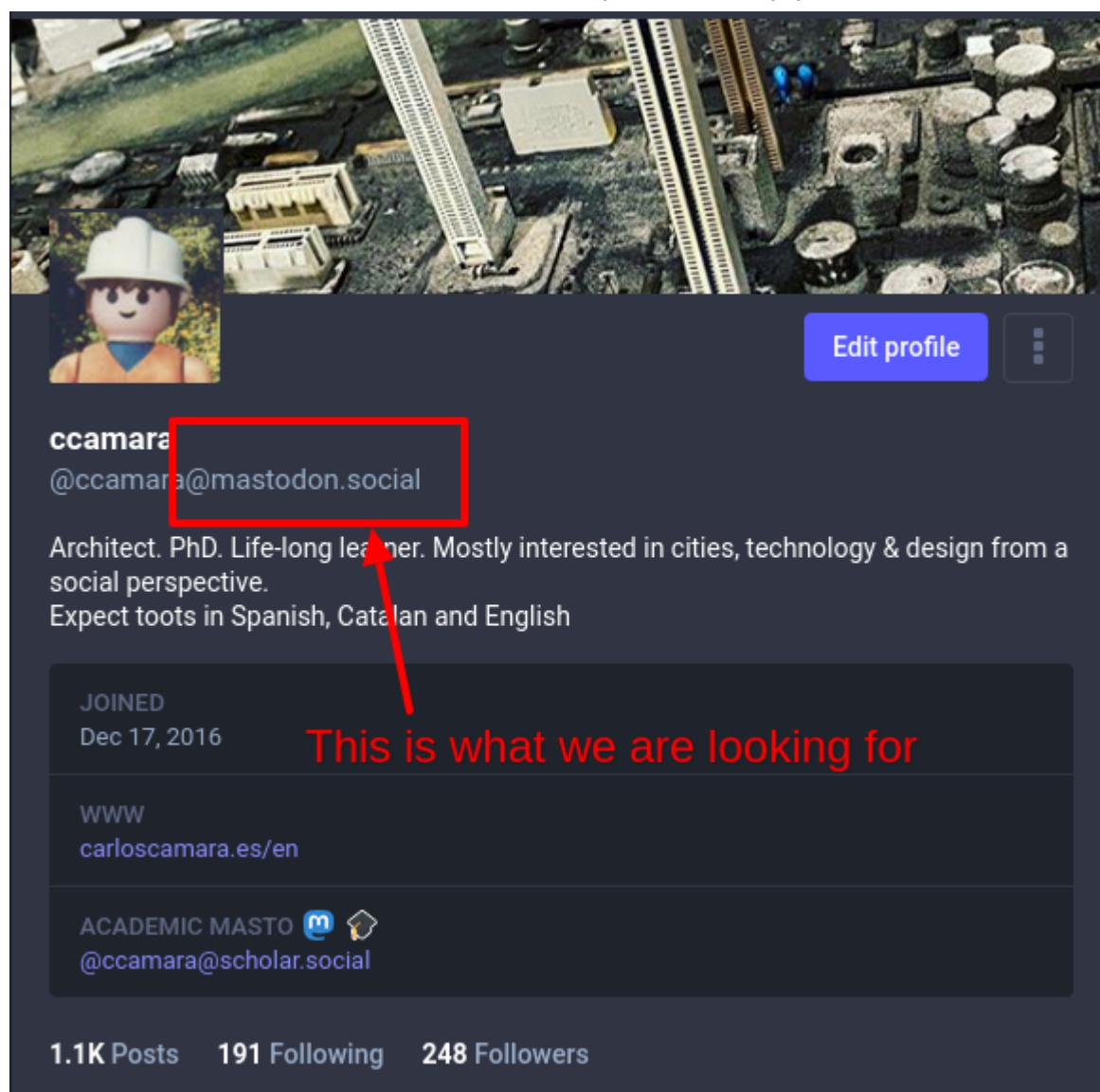
Rate how easy or difficult was to perform the following tasks

	Extremely difficult	Somewhat Difficult	Somewhat easy	Extremely easy	I do not know
Choose a server/instance	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Create an account	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Find people to follow	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Publish content	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Interact with people	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Follow trending topics	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Tag/Mention other users	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Instances

Select the name of your server(s) /instance(s)

You can select more than one option, if applicable



- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ mastodon.social | ☐ sciences.social |
| ☐ mastodon.online | ☐ zirk.us |
| ☐ mstdn.social | ☐ fosstodon.org |
| ☐ mastodon.uno | ☐ tech.lgbt |
| ☐ masto.ai | ☐ lgbt.io |
| ☐ scholar.social | ☐ Other servers not listed here |

(OPTIONAL) Please, write the name of your
server(s) / instance(s) below

If you have more than one, please separate multiple values with
commas: i.e. `mastodon.social, mastodon.lol...`

Please state how important these aspects are for you
when choosing your instance/server

Select the level of importance that best describes your case

	Not at all important	Not very important	Somewhat important	Very important	I do not know
Geographical location	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Topic	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Language	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Code of conduct	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
LGBT+ friendly	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Instance's manager(s)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Number of users	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Free account (no subscription costs)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Signup requires admin to approve/verify the account	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mastodon version	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How often have you observed these situations on Mastodon?

(It doesn't necessarily mean that you have been the subject of those situations)

	Never	Rarely	Often	Very Frequently	I do not know
Harassment towards certain users	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Hate speech towards certain demographics	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fake news	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Shadowbanning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Unwanted content	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Image descriptions (text descriptions for visually impaired)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Respectful, constructive conversations	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Please, choose which option best describes each of the following statements

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Agree	Strongly agree	I do not know
Mastodon is easy to use	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mastodon is a safe space for social interactions	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mastodon is welcoming to new users	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I can find interesting and relevant content in Mastodon	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I can find interesting and relevant people in Mastodon	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I trust my mastodon's server/instance admin	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mastodon's social conventions contribute to make Mastodon a better place	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What's your current level of satisfaction with Mastodon?

Extremely
dissatisfied ☐ Dissatisfied ☐ Satisfied ☐ Extremely
satisfied ☐ I do not know ☐

Select the statement that best reflects how do you plan to use Mastodon in the near future

- ☐ I will be using it as my only social network
- ☐ I will be using it as my main social network
- ☐ I will be using it as one of my social networks
- ☐ I will be using it with less frequency
- ☐ I will not be using it in the near future
- ☐ I still don't know if I will be using it consistently

OPTIONAL: What do you like the most of Mastodon so far?

OPTIONAL: What do you like the least of Mastodon so

far?



Fediverse

Mastodon is just a part of the Fediverse. We'd like to know how familiar you are with it

How familiar are you with the following concepts

	I do not know what it is	I have some idea about what it s	I have a very good understanding of what it is
Instance	☐	☐	☐
Federation	☐	☐	☐
Local timeline	☐	☐	☐
Federated timeline	☐	☐	☐
Fediverse	☐	☐	☐
ActivityPub	☐	☐	☐

Can you name any other Fediverse's software/services?
Separate multiple values with commas (option 1, option 2)

Twitter

How long have you been using Twitter?

- ☐ Less than one year
- ☐ Between one year and three
- ☐ More than three years

How often have you observed these situations on Twitter?

(It doesn't necessarily mean that you have been the subject of those situations)

	Never	Rarely	Often	Very Frequently	I do not know
Harassment towards certain users	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Hate speech towards certain demographics	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fake news	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Shadowbanning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Unwanted content	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Image descriptions (text descriptions for visually impaired)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Respectful, constructive conversations	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What's your current level of satisfaction with Twitter?

Extremely dissatisfied Somewhat dissatisfied Somewhat satisfied Extremely satisfied I do not know

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Select the statement that best reflects how do you plan to use Twitter in the near future

- ☐ I will be using it as my only social network
- ☐ I will be using it as my main social network
- ☐ I will be using it as one of my social networks
- ☐ I will be using it with less frequency
- ☐ I will not be using it in the near future
- ☐ I still don't know if I will be using it consistently

Optional section

OPTIONAL SECTION:

We appreciate you've already spent a considerable amount of your time filling this survey already, so the last three questions are optional (but much appreciated)

Would you be interested in taking part of a network of researchers aimed at researching on Mastodon?

If so, write your mastodon handle /username below

☐ Yes

☐ No

Would you be willing to be contacted for further research (i.e. participating in a focus group, informed about our developments...)

☐ Yes

☐ No

OPTIONAL: Do you want to add your mastodon handle so we can contact you for the aforementioned purposes?

Separate multiple answers with commas: `username@domain, username2@domain2...`

OPTIONAL: Is there anything you want to tell us about

mastodon or the survey that we haven't asked?



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